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THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp. * * * * *

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Apple and Google** restored the TikTok video-sharing app to their mobile app stores Thursday night, after getting reassurances from Attorney General Pam Bondi that they wouldn't face legal consequences. **B1**

◆ **Elon Musk** said he would withdraw his \$97.4 billion bid for the nonprofit that controls OpenAI if the board stopped its conversion to a for-profit company. **B1**

◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** advanced, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow industrials gaining 1.04%, 1.5% and 0.8%, respectively. **B9**

◆ **SpaceX** signaled it could soon be ready for its next Starship test flight, even as the vehicle remains grounded after a failed previous launch rained rocket parts across the Caribbean. **B1**

◆ **The Atlantic, Politico**, Vox and other publishers sued artificial-intelligence startup Cohere for copyright and trademark infringement, escalating the news industry's legal battle over the technology. **B1**

◆ **Honda and Nissan** officially scrapped their planned merger less than two months after announcing it, putting pressure on Nissan to look for other partnerships. **B1**

◆ **Nestlé** reported its weakest annual organic sales growth in more than a quarter of a century after consumers pulled back. **B2**

World-Wide

◆ **Vice President JD Vance** said the U.S. would hit Russia with sanctions and potentially military action if Putin won't agree to a peace deal with Ukraine that guarantees Kyiv's long-term independence. **A1, A7**

◆ **The Justice Department's** order to dismiss charges against New York Mayor Eric Adams triggered a series of resignations and ignited a feud between top Trump appointees and career prosecutors. **A1**

◆ **Trump** ordered federal agencies to explore how to adjust U.S. tariffs to match those of other countries, a move that threatens international rules that have been in place for decades. **A1**

◆ **The White House** stepped up the firing of federal workers who have been on the job for less than a year, the next phase of its personnel cuts. **A3**

◆ **Tim Walz** is trying to decide whether to run for a U.S. Senate seat or seek a third term as Minnesota's governor, a person familiar with his thinking said. **A4**

◆ **A storm** hit the Los Angeles region, flooding streets, prompting evacuation warnings and threatening mudslides in fire-ravaged areas. **A3**

◆ **Egypt** sought support for an Arab-led and -funded initiative to rebuild the Gaza Strip in hopes of neutralizing a Trump plan that is wildly unpopular across the Arab world. **A8**

CONTENTS Markets..... B9
Arts in Review... A10-11 Markets Digest... B7
Business & Finance B2 Opinion..... A13-15
Business News..... B3 Sports..... A12
Crossword..... A11 Technology..... B4
Heard on Street... B10 U.S. News..... A2-6
Mansion..... M1-20 World News A7-8, A16



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Car Plows Into Crowd in Munich, Days Before Vote



WOLFGANG RATTAY/REUTERS

RAMMED: Police examine the car they said accelerated into a crowd of people in Munich, Germany, Thursday, injuring at least 30, 10 days before a national election. Police detained the driver, an Afghan refugee, in what they said was a suspected attack. **A16**

Trump Family Reaps Bonanza, Making Millions Since Election

When Amazon.com founder Jeff Bezos dined with Donald Trump and his wife Melania at Mar-a-Lago in December,

By Rebecca Ballhaus,
Dana Mattioli and
Annie Linskey

there was a lot at stake for both men: Bezos, a titan of industry whose company is crucial to the U.S. economy, was

rebuilding his relationship with a resurgent and powerful soon-to-be president.

A lot was at stake for Melania, too: She was looking for a buyer for a documentary about her transition back to first lady. Her agent had pitched the film, which she would produce, to a number of studios, including Amazon's.

As the meeting approached, Melania consulted with direc-

tor Brett Ratner on how to sell her idea to the world's third-richest man. Melania regaled Bezos and his fiancée Lauren Sánchez with the project's details at dinner.

Just over two weeks later, Amazon, a company that prides itself on frugality and sharp negotiating, agreed to pay \$40 million to license the film—the most Amazon had ever spent on a documentary

and nearly three times the next-closest offer.

Netflix and Apple declined even to bid. Paramount made a lowball \$4 million distribution-rights offer. Disney, the most interested studio besides Amazon, offered \$14 million.

"We licensed the upcoming Melania Trump documentary film and series for one reason and one reason only—because *Please turn to page A9*

In a New Gold Rush, Banks Fly Bars to U.S.

By JOE WALLACE

If you landed on a flight from Europe to New York's John F. Kennedy International Airport recently, you might have been an unwitting participant in a high-stakes, high-altitude trade by gold dealers at JPMorgan Chase.

President Trump's threatened tariffs on Europe have thrown precious-metal markets into disarray. Gold prices have been driven to record highs, and a yawning gap has opened in the value of the yellow metal in its two trading hubs, New York and London.

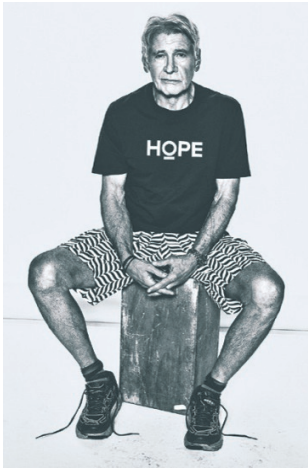
Gold is, for the moment,

worth substantially more in Manhattan than in the U.K. capital, sparking the biggest trans-Atlantic movement of physical bars in years. Traders at major banks are racing to yank gold from vaults deep below London's medieval streets and from Swiss gold refineries and ferry them across the ocean.

The cheapest way to transport such a valuable commodity safely: the cargo hold of commercial planes.

Gold futures in New York have risen 11% this year, closing Thursday at \$2,925.90 a troy ounce, and some analysts project they could soon hit *Please turn to page A6*

TOMORROW



WSJ.
MAGAZINE

HARRISON FORD

Vance Threatens Russia on Ukraine

By BOJAN PANCEVSKI
AND ALEXANDER WARD

PARIS—Vice President JD Vance said Thursday that the U.S. would hit Moscow with sanctions and potentially military action if President Vladimir Putin of Russia won't agree to a peace deal with Ukraine that guarantees Kyiv's long-term independence.

Vance said the option of sending U.S. troops to Ukraine if Moscow failed to negotiate in good faith remained "on the table," striking a far tougher tone than Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth, who suggested on Wednesday the U.S.

wouldn't commit forces.

"There are economic tools of leverage, there are of course military tools of leverage" the U.S. could use against Putin, Vance said.

In an interview with The Wall Street Journal hours after President Trump said he would start negotiating with Putin to end the war in Ukraine, Vance said: "I think there is a deal that is going to come out of this that's going to shock a lot of people."

The vice president's re- *Please turn to page A6*

◆ **Trump agrees to Putin demand on talks..... A7**

These Adults Swear By Kids' Menus

* * *
Smaller portions,
prices are a draw;
prizes are a bonus

By ROSHAN FERNANDEZ
AND HEATHER HADDON

Ashley Garrett thinks restaurant portions are too big and expensive, and she hates leftovers. Her solution isn't to eat out less. It's to order from the kids' menu.

"Give me chicken tenders or a basic pasta dish, and I'm happy," said the 33-year-old, who orders kids' meals about five times a week. *Please turn to page A6*

Adams Prosecutors Quit Over Order to Drop Case

The Justice Department's order to dismiss charges against New York City Mayor Eric Adams triggered a series of resignations on Thursday and ignited a feud between top Trump appointees and career prosecutors.

By Sadie Gurman,
Corinne Ramey
and James Fanelli

The departures started with Danielle Sassoon, a longtime federal prosecutor who refused to comply with the demand to drop the case. President Trump had elevated Sassoon to be the acting U.S. attorney in Manhattan after he took office.

Others followed suit, in-

cluding the senior-most career official in the Justice Department's criminal division, Kevin Driscoll, and the head of the department's public-integrity section, John Keller. They left when it became clear they would be ordered to dismiss the case after Sassoon refused, people familiar with the matter said. Three other supervisors in the Justice Department's public-integrity unit also resigned Thursday, one of the people said.

Sassoon wrote in a letter to Attorney General Pam Bondi: "Because the law does not support a dismissal, and because I am confident that Adams has committed the crimes with which he is charged, I *Please turn to page A4*

RFK Jr. Wins Confirmation



OATH OF OFFICE: Robert F. Kennedy Jr., a longtime vaccine critic, was sworn in Thursday by Justice Neil Gorsuch after the Senate voted to confirm him as health secretary. **A4**